

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS



REALISM IN INDIAN FOREIGN POLICY

MODULE - 5

PAKISTAN'S VICTORY?

- 1 According to the Pakistani military, 1965 War envisaged (conceived a possibility) a sabotage of military targets, disruption of communications on a short term.
- 2 As an outcome in the long run, it envisaged distribution of arms to the people of occupied Kashmir and initiation of a guerrilla movement to start an uprising in Kashmir.



TASHKENT AGREEMENT

The Prime Minister of India and the President of Pakistan met at Tashkent on January 10, 1966 and discussed relations between the two countries.

The Prime Minister of India and the President of Pakistan agreed to

- 1 Promote good neighbourly relations in accordance with the United Nations Charter.
- 2 Resolve dispute peacefully and not through the use of force
- 3 Withdraw all armed personnel by 25 February, 1966 to the positions they held prior to 5 August, 1965, and observe the cease-fire terms on the cease-fire line.



TASHKENT AGREEMENT

- 4 Relations would be based on the principle of non-interference in the internal affairs of the other.
- 5 Restore normal functioning of diplomatic missions, observe the Vienna Convention of 1961 on Diplomatic Intercourse.
- 6 Adopt measures towards the restoration of economic and trade relations, communications, as well as cultural exchanges
- 7 Continue discussions on problems of refugees and illegal immigrations and give instructions to their respective authorities to carry out the repatriation of prisoners of war.
- 8 Create conditions to prevent the exodus of people.



TASHKENT AGREEMENT

- 1 Soviet Union was appreciated for its good offices and a constructive role it played in bringing mutually satisfactory results.
- 2 India and Pakistan were under pressure from USSR, US and UN to peacefully resolve the dispute
- 3 In India, people were disappointed with the agreement as it did not contain a 'No War' clause. Soon after 1965, India went on a war against Pakistan in 1971.



MYSTERY OF SHASTRI'S DEATH

- 1 Soon after signing the agreement, PM Shastri passed away. Although officially it was maintained that Shastri died of heart attack, his widow, Lalita Shastri kept alleging that her husband was poisoned.
- 2 Many believed that Shastri's body turning blue was an evidence of his poisoning.
- 3 Indeed a Russian butler attending to him was arrested on suspicion of poisoning Shastri, but was later absolved of charges.
- 4 The government also admitted that no postmortem examination had been conducted on him in USSR, but it did have a report of a medical investigation conducted by Shastri's personal physician Dr. R. N. Chugh and some Russian doctors.



INDIRA GANDHI'S FOREIGN POLICY

- 1 Indira Gandhi was sworn in as the Prime Minister after the sudden demise of PM Shastri in 1966.
- 2 Her foreign policy was a continuation of Non-Alignment with pragmatic considerations. She was realistic and wanted to assert herself both domestically as well as internationally.
- 3 She responded to the geopolitical situation of the time. Hence deviations or variations from Non-alignment can be understood through the strategic arrangement.
- 4 India's regional dominance grew under Indira Gandhi. Some of her actions made a bold statement, showed her leadership skills and enhanced her international stature. Unlike, PM Nehru, she had a greater inclination towards coercive means.
- 5 Her focus on self reliance did not confine to political independence but also independence from foreign assistance.



OFFICIAL VISIT TO USA

1 PM Gandhi visited USA in 1966 in the backdrop of depleting foreign reserves and domestic food crisis.

2 The visit was to exchange views and establish greater understanding of the priorities of both countries, discuss the US-Pakistan axis and sale of arms to Pakistan

3 After the meeting, USA agreed to supply food and \$9million aid to India.

4 On the question of Kashmir, the PM clarified that the situation in Kashmir was not conducive for a plebiscite. India was not in a position to afford another partition.



INDIRA GANDHI IN NEPAL

Indira Gandhi visited Nepal in 1966.

- 1 Nepal is important to India- historically, geographically, economically and culturally.
- 2 The countries share an open border and free movement of people.
- 3 Indo-Nepal Treaty of Peace and Friendship 1950

- India and Nepal would have reciprocal treatment of Indian and Nepali citizens in matters of residence, property, business and movement.
- National treatment would be given to Indian and Nepali businesses.
- Nepal would get military assistance and weaponry from India.



INDIRA GANDHI IN NEPAL

4

Treaty of Trade and Transit in 1960 to

- Exchange goods between the respective territories.
- Encourage collaboration in economic development.
- Facilitate trade with Third World countries.

5

In 1966 meeting, Nepal wanted discussion on

- 1960 Treaty on Trade and Transit.
- Impact of devaluation of the Indian rupee on Nepal's exports to India.
- Assistance from India for Nepal's Third Plan.



However, there was no substantial decision taken on any of these issues at the meeting.

CHINA ENTERING NEPAL

- 1 In 1965, China was building a road from Kathmandu to Pokhara.
- 2 Scholars in India, felt India had favorable relations with the Nepali government and China could not use it to make inroads into Nepal.
- 3 Nepal in 1966, received more aid from India than any other country.
- 4 95 percent of Nepal's foreign trade was with India.

- 5 India even provided military material to Nepal on the principle of non-reciprocity and allowed Nepal to import other arms and ammunitions from India necessary for its security.



INTEGRATION OF SIKKIM

- 1 Sikkim had always been strategically important and since independence, it was an important state between India and China.
- 2 After independence, the British officer in Sikkim was replaced by an Indian officer. PM Nehru never wanted to use force to annex Sikkim.
- 3 The 1962 Indo-China war was a turning point in Indo-Sikkim relations as it further enhanced the importance of Sikkim for India.



WHY SIKKIM INTEGRATED?

- 1 By 1967, India feared that Tibet could become China's gateway into India's North-east.
- 2 Internally, the Nepali population became vocal in Sikkim, and wanted a democratic government instead of Monarchy in Sikkim.
- 3 For this, they looked for Indian support. India provided monetary support to these demonstrations and pressurized the Chogyal government in Sikkim.
- 4 In April 1973, a protest in Sikkim became unmanageable and the Chogyal requested India to take control.
- 5 India took full control but retained Chogyal as the constitutional monarchy.



INDIA'S ROLE IN VIETNAM

- 1 India's role in the Vietnam war displays a policy shift and PM Gandhi's foreign policy in the extended neighborhood.
- 2 It was a displacement of Nehru's peacemaker role conception with an alternative security seeker role.
- 3 North Vietnam had supported China in the 1962 war as it was dependent upon China for economic and military support.
- 4 US was waging a war against the spread of Communism and against the Communists of North Vietnam.
- 5 In spite of North Vietnam's support for China, Indian PM spoke strongly against US actions in Vietnam.
- 6 For India, US had been supplying wheat under Public law (PL) 480. It was also helping India with deferred payments.



PM GANDHI IN SRI LANKA

PM Gandhi's foreign policy was based on Indian strategic compulsions as well as Cold War calculations.

- 1 Sri Lanka, during the Cold War aligned with the US. India was suspicious in 1984 that Britain was training the Sri Lankan military.
- 2 Indira Gandhi on the issue of Tamil Eelam movement of the 1980s, asked Britain not to help Sri Lanka with military aid and anti-insurgency assistance.
- 3 India held a meeting in Bhutan between the two sides involved in the ethnic conflict in Sri Lanka. However, these talks failed.

- 4 The issue of Tamil liberation concerned people of Indian origin and India wanted a resolution of the issue.



INDIA'S INVOLVEMENT IN SRI LANKA

- 1 India implicitly allowed the LTTE and other militant groups to set up base in Tamil Nadu.
- 2 India was giving military training to Tamil youths. The Tamil separatist also received funding and weapons privately.
- 3 The Tamil Nadu government also provided monetary support. The Sri Lankan Navy was not sophisticated and it helped LTTE fighters to evade scrutiny.



INDIA'S INVOLVEMENT IN SRI LANKA

4 India began getting refugees from Sri Lanka in 1983. In 1983, PM Gandhi asserted that India will not take refugees from Sri Lanka and that India follows the principle of non-refoulement and voluntary repatriation.

5 Gandhi wanted the issue in Sri Lanka to escalate to a point where she could negotiate to settle the Tamil issue. But by the time she could take action, she got assassinated.



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